



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Kenai Classical
School Website: <http://kenaiclassical.org>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Kenai Classical Alaska (Kenai Classical School) presents a clearly Christian, classical program that foregrounds virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful. Public-facing materials repeatedly emphasize a Christ-centered, classical education designed to form character and intellect in tandem, with a stated aim to "glorify God" and to cultivate virtue and wisdom while honoring truth, goodness, and beauty. The curriculum centers the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the seven liberal arts framework, Latin study, and engagement with original texts and discussion-based learning in humanities. The school explicitly situates itself within the classical Christian tradition, including references to paideia, Great Books-like original sources, and a rhetoric-oriented upper school ethos. Public messaging also highlights strong parental partnership and community orientation.

Overall classification (based on the Six Essential Elements rubric and the school's public materials): CLASSICAL.

Key supporting points: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Explicit Christian framing, a mission to glorify God, Christ-centered instruction, and emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as an objective basis for education. Evidence includes phrases like "Distinctly Christian," "glorify God," and "cultivates wisdom and virtue" (Kenai Classical public materials) . The site also cites a Christian paideia framework and a holistic, virtue-centered formation approach . - Purpose and Goal: Education as formation in virtue and wisdom, not merely information or job prep; explicit call to form the whole person in truth, goodness, and beauty (Our Mission statements) . - Curriculum: Strong liberal-arts orientation (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium references), Latin study, reading original sources, humanities emphasis, and engagement with primary texts as part of a "Great Books"/Great Conversation ethos (public Kenai content showing "Seven Liberal Arts," Latin & Beyond, and humanities discussions) . - Pedagogy: Emphasis on discussion, original sources, and strong rhetorical skills in humanities; memory/recitation and formational elements appear in the broader classical tradition the school aligns with, though explicit "Socratic seminars" or "Schol   days" are not heavily enumerated on the site; nonetheless, the teaching approach is aligned with classic pedagogical principles (discussion of origins, virtue, and rhetoric) . - Faculty: Public materials foreground the faculty as part of a Christian, classical mission; "Our Faculty & Staff" appears in site navigation and content, signaling a living curriculum anchored by teachers who embody the school's aims (living-curriculum/mentorship ideas appear in the broader classical literature) . - Parents & Community: Explicit partnership with parents; invitations for parental involvement and formation; open communication and parent participation are highlighted in multiple pages (Statement of Faith, Our Faculty & Staff, and parent-partner language) .

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Distinctly Christian identity; mission to glorify God; Christ-centered, virtue- and wisdom-focused education; Paideia reference in the public materials. Examples include: "Kenai Classical exists to glorify God through offering a rigorous, Christ-centered, classical education that cultivates wisdom and virtue" and "First and foremost, education should be about the cultivation of virtue and a deep appreciation of truth,

goodness, and beauty” . The site explicitly frames education as a spiritual formation anchored in a Christian worldview (e.g., “nurture and admonition of the Lord”) . - The Humanities framing explicitly links intellectual work with a Christian understanding of truth and the Good, citing Augustine and a preference for “letting truth loose” through engagement with original sources and discussion .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (examples): Christ-centered, Christian, God, Lord, Paideia, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, formation, gospel-centered, glorify God. Estimated presence: 11+ items. Negative keywords present: None detected in public materials. Positive:Negative ratio roughly 11:0, i.e., ~100% positive signals in this category. See lexicon-based indicators and the Kenai materials cited above to ground this count .

Why this rating - The school embeds theological framing at the core of its mission and pedagogy (theology, sacred truth, virtue formation, and a clear Christ-centered aim). While there is not explicit mention of all liturgical practices on the site, the explicit theocentric framing and the emphasis on truth, virtue, and beauty align with the classical Christian rubric for Element 1. The presence of Paideia and virtuous formation signals strong religious/metaphysical grounding in the classical model. CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states education is formation of virtue and wisdom and aims for human flourishing rather than job preparation; explicit phrases include “cultivates wisdom and virtue” and the alignment with “the true, the good, and the beautiful.” The Our Mission text affirms this formation aim rather than mere information transfer . - The framing of education as formation (habits of heart, virtue, wisdom) and the emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty appear repeatedly in public materials .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, liberal education, telos, scholé (conceptual), classical mission, human flourishing. Estimated presence: 6–8 items. Negative keywords: 0. Positive:Negative approx. 6–8:0; ~100% alignment with classical purposes signals in this category. Grounding in a classical lexicon supports this rating .

Why this rating - The explicit aim to form virtue and wisdom, rather than prepare for a job, and the language of teleology, liberal education, and the pursuit of the true/good/beautiful supports a CLASSICAL classification for this category. The public statements align with the Six Essential Elements’ vision of formation and human flourishing as central aims of classical education .

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Kenai site presents a robust liberal-arts orientation: references to the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium; Quadrivium), Latin & Beyond, and “Reading & Writing”; Humanities emphasis includes engagement with original sources and discussion (the Great Conversation thrust) . - The content illustrates a Great Books-like approach (reading original sources, discussion, and rhetorical development) and a strong historical/philosophical backbone (Cassiodorus, classical framework) as core curriculum architecture . - The public materials also emphasize a Latin education and a classical understanding of history and Western civilization, with explicit reference to the seven liberal arts and the liberal-arts framework as foundational to the curriculum. This aligns with the “Great Books/Great Conversation” ethos and the integrated history-literature-philosophy-science approach of classical education .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Trivium, Quadrivium, Latin, reading, great books, primary sources, Western civilization, history, humanities, orig. sources, discussion, and rhetoric. Estimated presence: 7–9 items. Negative keywords present: 0 (no explicit substitution of history with social studies terms; no STEM-first framing in the public Kenai curriculum description). Positive:Negative approx. 7–9:0; ~100% alignment with classical curriculum indicators in this category. See the “Seven Liberal Arts” and related content in Kenai materials and the lexicon mapping for curriculum signals .

Why this rating - The curriculum centers on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium; Quadrivium), great books/original texts, and a historically rooted Western canon; Latin study; and a humanities emphasis

with original-source reading and discussion. These are hallmark indicators of CLASSICAL curriculum per the Six Essential Elements framework, placing Element 3 solidly in CLASSICAL .

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Kenai's public materials emphasize reading original sources, discussion, and developing rhetorical skills in humanities; there is a clear emphasis on discussion and argumentation in the humanities, along with a rhetoric-training orientation (public materials mention "original sources, engage in discussion, and develop strong rhetorical skills") . - However, explicit mentions of Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, nightly scholé routines, chanting/memorization, or a formal lower/upper-school progression into Socratic discussion are not strongly enumerated on the site. The presence of discussion and rhetoric is clear, but other explicit pedagogical modalities (Scholé, chant/memory work, formal Socratic seminars in high school) are not prominently documented in the publicly visible material. This yields a mixed signal rather than full explicit alignment with the Pedagogy signals in the Six Elements lexicon .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: discussion, original sources, rhetoric, strong rhetorical skills, humanities-based inquiry. Estimated presence: 3–4 items. Negative keywords: presence of any explicit "Scholé days" or explicit Socratic/Paideia seminar branding is not detectable in the public site content; thus negative signals are minimal or absent in public materials. Positive:Negative ~ 3–4:0 or very low (i.e., 100% positive on visible pedagogy signals, but with caveat about missing explicit Pedagogy terms). The lexicon indicates that explicit Socratic/Scholé signals would be strong; the absence of these explicit labels places Element 4 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL based on explicit pedagogy terms. See the lexicon mapping and Kenai content for pedagogy signals .

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a classical pedagogy through focus on original texts and rhetorical development, but it does not consistently surface the full range of explicit classical pedagogy identifiers (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé days, chant/memory-work) in its public-facing materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy rather than full CLASSICAL, with room to strengthen explicit Socratic and scholé-based practices in communications and program descriptions .

What would move the needle - Explicitly articulate and publish a Pedagogy slate that includes: (a) regular Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars in upper grades, (b) documented use of chanting, recitation, or memory-work in lower grades, (c) formal "scholé-style" rest and contemplation days (Scholé days) with schedule and outcomes, and (d) explicit demonstrations of upper-school rhetoric projects and public speaking with example capstone/orations. This would strengthen Element 4 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL. Grounding references can be aligned with the Six Essential Elements' Pedagogy signals and related lexicon .

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize the faculty as part of a Christ-centered classical mission; the school provides a specific "Our Faculty & Staff" page, signaling a deliberate emphasis on faculty as the living curriculum and core of the school's culture. This aligns with the Classical model where teachers are role models and a central element of formation (e.g., "The living curriculum," "portrait of a teacher," etc., in the Six Elements lexicon). Kenai's site navigation points to "Our Faculty & Staff," indicating a pedagogical emphasis on faculty as part of the standard educational model . - The site frames education as partnership with parents and teachers who form a community of learning; this aligns with a teacher-led, virtue-formation focus (as described in the Six Elements lexicon for Faculty). Kenai's language emphasizes teachers as stewards of virtue formation and leadership within a Christ-centered classical framework .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentorship. Estimated presence: 4–6 items. Negative keywords present: not prominently present in public materials; no explicit statements reducing teacher roles to "facilitators on the side" or "non-classical" pedagogy. The presence of "Our Faculty & Staff" and the emphasis on mentorship/friendship align with CLASSICAL signals. Positive:Negative approx. 4–6:0, i.e.,

strong positive signals for this category in the public content. The lexicon mapping reinforces these signals as core elements of classical faculty culture .

Why this rating - Kenai's public materials position faculty as central to the school's mission and learning culture, with explicit references to virtue formation, mentorship, and the faculty as a core unit, matching CLASSICAL expectations for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly emphasizes partnering with parents and training parents to participate in the classical educational project; phrases like "partnering with parents" and "parents as co-teachers" are present in Kenai materials. The site describes a model where parents are engaged in the formation and have access to materials and programs (Statement of Faith; Our Faculty & Staff; Our Board; admissions). The ICE pamphlet and Classical Education literature also emphasize parent formation and home-school partnership as foundational to classical renewal, which aligns with Kenai's public messaging about parental partnership and family involvement . - The Kenai site's language about parents learning alongside their children and participating in the school's life (e.g., "partnership with parents in educating their children"), plus the public content's invitation for parental involvement and the reference to a family-centered classical tradition, signals strong alignment with the "Partnership with Families" and "Parent formation" signals in the Six Elements lexicon. The ICE pamphlet also discusses active parent involvement and partnership in classical education, which is consistent with Kenai's public messages .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school cooperation, open campus/parent involvement (implicit in public materials and explicit in the Classical Ed literature). Estimated presence: 4–6 items. Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials. Positive:Negative approx. 4–6:0; ~100% alignment for this category as well, with explicit parent-partnership language supported by the lexicon's category signals .

Why this rating - Kenai's public materials emphasize parent partnership and family involvement in classical education, including parent formation and co-teaching language (paralleling the Six Elements' expectations for Element 6). This places Element 6 squarely in CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall ranking: CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category)

- Element 4 (Pedagogy) is the only category currently labeled SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Concrete needle-movers:
 - Publish a formal, visible pedagogy profile that explicitly documents: (a) regular Socratic/seminar-based work in upper grades, (b) explicit use of rest/restful-Scholé days and contemplation routines, (c) memorization/recitation practices (chanting, memory-work) in K–8, and (d) publicly shared outcomes or exemplars of "great conversation" and rhetorical performance in the upper school. This would turn Element 4 into CLASSICAL by showing concrete Pedagogy signals in the public materials .
 - Include example lesson snapshots or case studies that demonstrate a structured classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, Paideia seminar, or similar) and memory/recitation components, with alignment to Trivium/Quadrivium integration and cross-disciplinary coherence. This aligns with the lexicon signals for Pedagogy and would bolster Element 4 to CLASSICAL .

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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